

I enjoyed hours of binge-watching Netflix on the device along with some YouTube videos and loved the overall experience. The brightness was just right even in a well-lit office environment and the colours seemed to pop without being oversaturated.

Now about the speakers, they are clear enough to attend video calls. However, if you want to watch content in all its glory, the speakers might be a let-down. It is better to either plug your headphones in or go for an external speaker system.

PERFORMANCE AND BENCHMARKS

In terms of performance and benchmarks, the Dell Plus 14 2-in-1 displayed plenty of muscle. I used the laptop for attending virtual meetings, browsing endless tabs in Chrome, doodling in tablet mode, and so on. Not once did the laptop flinch, showed signs of slowing down, or hung up on me. Apps loaded instantly and allowed me to multitask, the in-built webcam worked wonderfully allowing me to look my best during virtual meetings and the Dell Pen glided through the surface during those doodling sessions on MS Paint. We'll speak more about doodling in a while..

In the 3D Mark Nightraid benchmark test, the laptop scored 22,569 points which puts it comfortably ahead of the likes of Asus Vivobook 16 (21719), HP Omnibook 3 (21200) and Acer Swift 14 Go AI (16203).

In PCMark 10 benchmark too, the laptop scored 7385 points, which is more than that of Asus Vivobook 16, HP Omnibook 3, Asus Vivobook S16 and Acer Swift 14 Go AI.

In the Cinebench R23 benchmark, the laptop's score was 11,100, which is higher than HP Omnibook 3, Asus Vivobook S16 and Acer Swift 14 Go AI but lower than Asus Vivobook 16 (14,182).

In Geekbench 6 benchmark, the laptop once again shined and scored ahead of most in this price segment. With 2821 points, the laptop is ahead of Asus Vivobook 16, HP Omnibook 3, Asus

Vivobook S16 and Acer Swift 14 Go AI.

To test the SSD speed, I ran the PCMark full SSD benchmark test on the device and it impressed yet again with a pretty good score of 2226. This is a decent score which puts the laptop ahead of Asus Vivobook S16, Vivobook 16, Acer Swift 14 AI and Dell Latitude 2-in-1. The HP Omnibook 3, with a score of 2362, was a couple of points ahead.

TABLET MODE AND DELL PEN EXPERIENCE

One of the biggest highlights of the Dell 14 Plus 2-in-1 is its versatility. With the 360-degree hinge, it easily transforms from a traditional laptop into a tablet within seconds. The transition feels smooth, and the compact size makes it comfortable to hold and use in tablet mode for extended periods. To truly test this, I handed the device over to my sister, who's a digital artist, and she spent about an hour sketching on it using the bundled Dell Pen.

The Dell Pen experience was a pleasant surprise. You just have to pop in a battery, connect it via Bluetooth, and it's instantly ready to use. The pairing process is quick and seamless – no unnecessary setup screens or complicated pairing steps. Once connected, the pen feels incredibly responsive. Each stroke is registered accurately, with no noticeable lag or jitter, even when sketching finer details. My sister appreciated how natural the pressure sensitivity felt on MS Paint, allowing her to draw with control and precision.

She ended up creating an entire digital sketch in under an hour, which speaks volumes about how capable this 2-in-1 setup is for artists, students, and anyone who loves to doodle or take handwritten notes.

Whether it's jotting down quick thoughts during a meeting or illustrating on the go, the Dell 14 Plus 2-in-1 handles it effortlessly, living up to its 'Plus' moniker in every sense.

BATTERY AND THERMALS

The Dell 14 Plus 2-in-1 will easily sail

through a full workday. I logged in around 9 AM and still had about 30 percent battery left by 5 PM. This was with consistent use involving typing, browsing multiple tabs, attending meetings, and the occasional YouTube break. I did leave the screen idle during lunch, but overall, the performance was steady and impressive.

Coming to thermals, they are also well-managed. On the surface, the laptop runs cool under regular workloads, and even after long sessions, it only gets mildly warm in the WASD region. The chassis and trackpad, however, remain cool to the touch, ensuring comfortable use throughout the day.

During a 30-minute Cinebench stress test, the temperature in the WASD area peaked at 38.7°C, while the IJKL region stayed around 33.7°C and the touchpad remained cooler at 27.5°C. This suggests Dell has done a great job when it comes to thermal management.

SHOULD YOU BUY?

The Dell 14 Plus 2-in-1 is a reliable companion for those who value portability, performance, and versatility equally. It delivers strong everyday performance, a gorgeous display, and the flexibility of a convertible design, making it ideal for those who switch between work, creativity, and entertainment on the go. While the port selection could have been better and the speakers aren't the loudest, these are small trade-offs for what is otherwise a solid all-rounder.

–Divyanshi Sharma

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: AMD Ryzen AI 7 350 | GPU: AMD Radeon 860M iGPU | RAM: 16GB 7500Hz DDR5 | Storage: 1 TB SSD | Display: 14-inch WVA (Wide Viewing Angle) | Refresh Rate: 60 Hz | Brightness: 300 nits | Camera: 1080p 30 fps FHD

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